COMP 3700A: Contributing to Open Source

Introduction

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September 9, 2026

Who am I?

Name: Charlotte Curtis

Pronouns: She/her

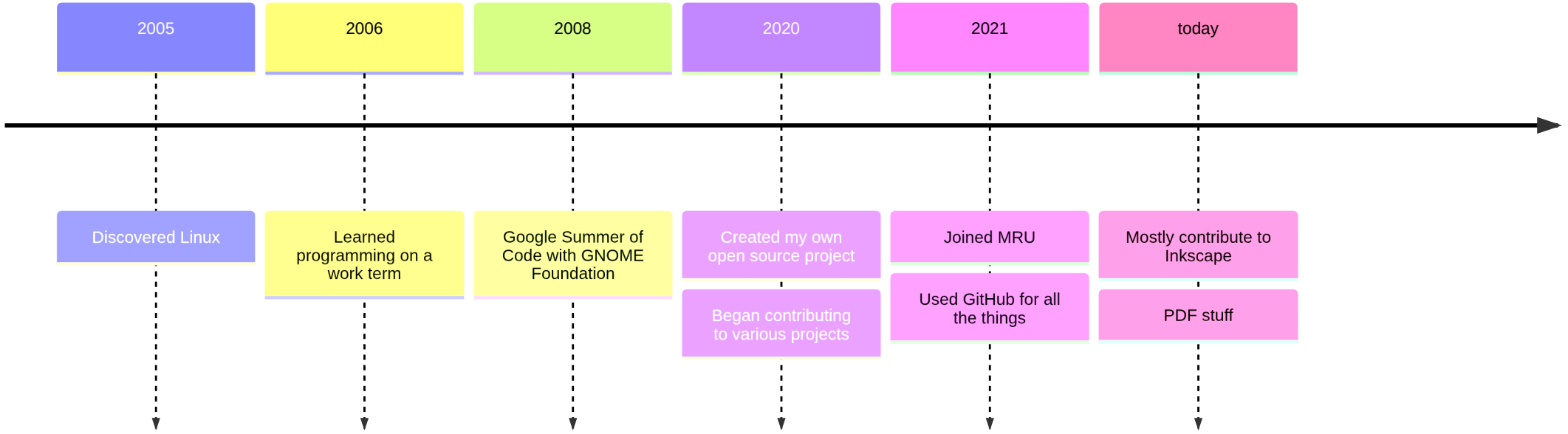
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My history with open source



> *I still have a lot to learn!*



Who are you?

Course content

- Some technical content on common tools and workflows, including git, forking and merging, yaml, markdown, grep
- The various roles and organizational structures of OSS projects
- Licensing and ownership
- Release cycles and continuous integration/deployment (CI/CD)
- Non code contributions
- Funding models

> *Probably some more things that I've forgotten*

Deliverables

Component	Weight
Lab activities	14%
Class participation	21%
Midterm (Oct 28)	15%
Term project (3 parts)	50%

- Midterm is the only exam
- Term project: contributing to a community of your choice
- Lots of discussion and sharing back to the class (3x presentations)
- Class participation includes contributing to course repo

What is Open Source?

You might see the terms:

- Free software
- Free open source software (FOSS)
- Free/libre open source software (FLOSS)
- Humanitarian free open source software (HFOSS)
- Open hardware
- Open educational resources
- and probably more!

Free as in freedom, not as in beer

Four essential freedoms, according to the Free Software Foundation:

0. **Run** the program as you wish
1. **Study** and **change** the program
2. **Redistribute copies**
3. Distribute your **modified versions**

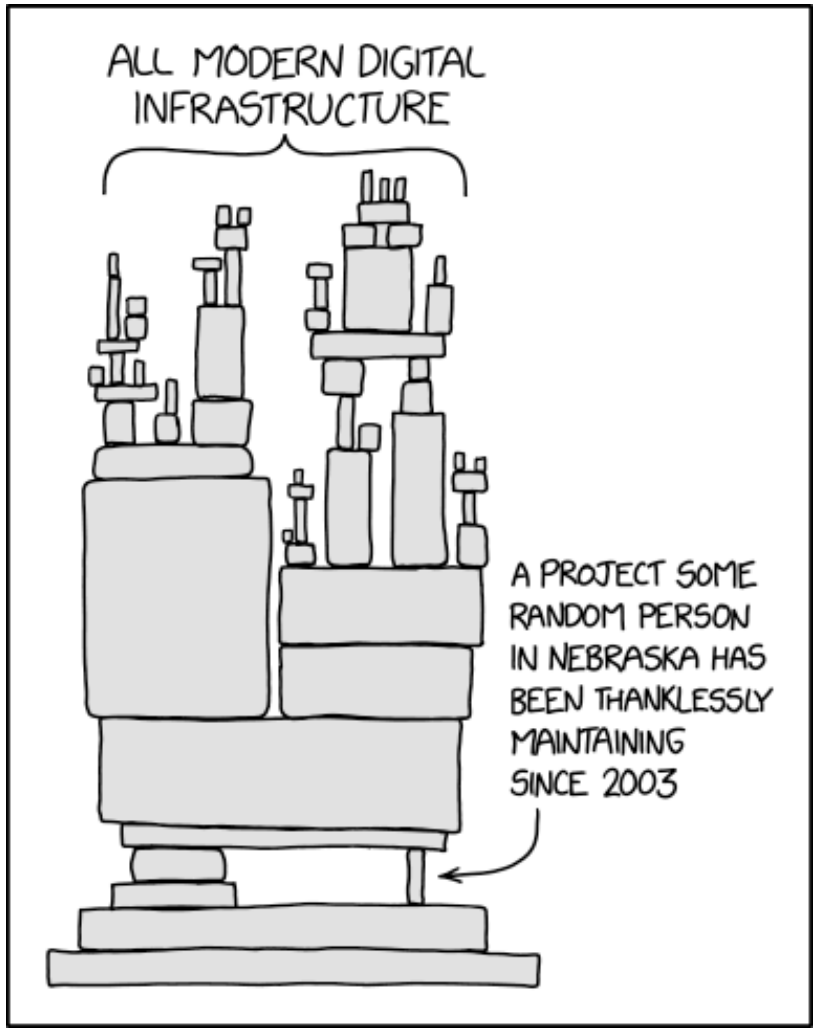
> *The Open Source Definition is somewhat looser, but essentially the same*
>
> *"Free" does not refer to cost!*

Why open source?



- More eyes -> more bugfixes
- Transparency -> better security
- Control over your own software
- Learning from others

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Why this course?

This course aims to provide:

- Exposure to real-world teams, projects, code, policies, procedures, etc
- Messy codebases
- Time and space to fail, learn, and contribute

> *Ultimate goal is to break down barriers*



What are some barriers to contributing to open source?

Where can you find OSS?

- You use it every day!
- Check out https://awesomeopensource.com
- Popular hosting platforms include:
  - GitHub
  - GitLab
  - CodeBerg
  - even email, such as for git itself

> ***Homework**: for next lecture, respond to the discussion post with links to 3-5 OSS projects that you use*